

mattered little. The resolution gave him what he wanted—a free hand to take whatever actions he deemed necessary in Vietnam.



### Signing the resolution

President Johnson signs the Tonkin Gulf Resolution—the “Joint resolution to promote the maintenance of international peace and security in Southeast Asia”—on August 10, 1964, in the White House East Room.

#### » AFTER

**Johnson would use the authority of the Tonkin Gulf Resolution to increase US involvement in Vietnam.**

#### **BOMBS AT THE READY**

Contingency planning for a bombing campaign in North Vietnam was already underway, but it took another **Viet Cong attack** to precipitate further US reprisal. A raid on the airfield at Pleiku—and the nearby helicopter base at Camp Holloway—on February 7, 1965, triggered the massive bombing campaign codenamed **Operation Rolling Thunder**.